# Answers and talk notes

Add and Subtract Decimals

### What your student is learning

Tonight we use decimal adding and subtracting in a running log — a weight that goes down when something is unloaded and up when something is loaded.

## Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **B.** Subtract. Unloading takes weight away, so subtract. So the answer is: Subtract.
2. **C.** 25.30 and 4.75, with the decimal points lined up. Write 25.3 as 25.30 and line up the decimal points: 25.30 and 4.75. So the answer is: 25.30 and 4.75, with the decimal points lined up.
3. **D.** 31.45. 50.20 − 18.75 = 31.45.
4. **B.** 95.75 kg. 120.50 − 40.25 = 80.25, then 80.25 + 15.50 = 95.75 kg.
5. **A.** 144.75 kg. 200.00 − 75.50 = 124.50, then 124.50 + 20.25 = 144.75 kg.

### Talk about it

For each step, did the balance go up or down, and how did you line up the numbers?

### Home mission

Pick a bag of rice or flour at home. Say it weighs 4.5 kg. Pretend you use 1.25 kg, then add 0.8 kg. Write a running log with the decimal points in a line.

### When they are stuck, ask

- Are the decimal points lined up in a straight column?
- Does this step add to the total or take away from it?
- Is the answer bigger or smaller than where we started? Should it be?

### Try not to say

- Just line up the last digits on the right.
- Adding a zero at the end changes the number, so do not.
- Do both steps at once to save time.